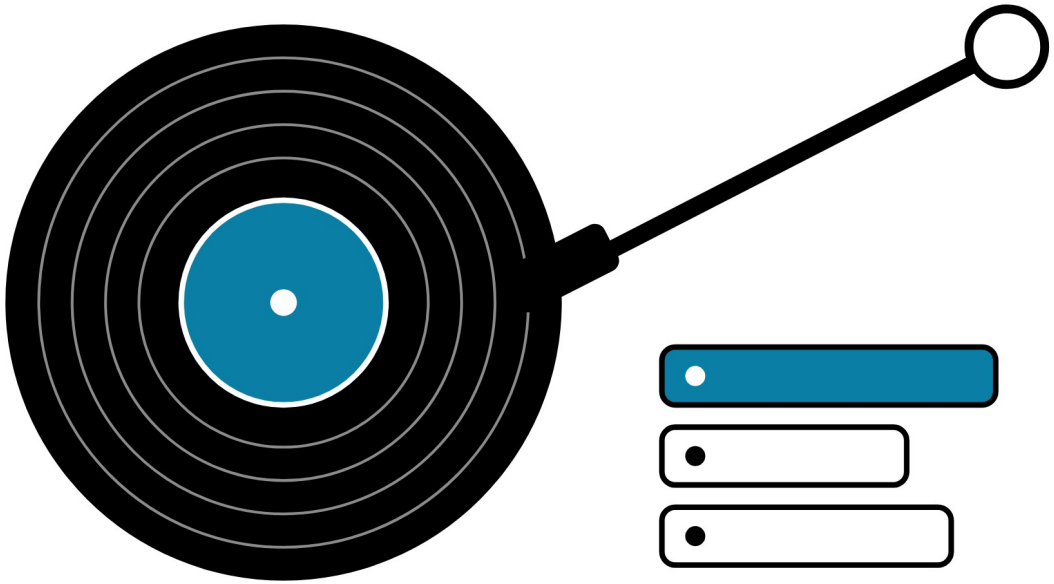
HUDSON BEAT



GENRE EXPLORATION

Step outside your comfort zone.

DIGITAL MUSIC PRODUCTION 2 · CLASS 1 · MAKE A TRACK IN A GENRE YOU DO NOT KNOW

THINK: A GENRE YOU WOULD SKIP

THINK, THEN SHARE

Teacher: no audio is needed. Ask the questions aloud and take a few answers.

- Which genre would you never choose to listen to?
- What do you think it sounds like, and how do you know?
- What would you need to find out to make it?

WHAT IS GENRE EXPLORATION?

- Pick a genre you are unfamiliar with
- Research what defines it
- Produce a track that captures its signature sound
- Goal: listen deeper and grow as a producer

SEVEN CLASSES

CLASS 1	What genre would you skip? · five steps · four words · research
CLASS 2	Genre fingerprint · production, not just instruments · before you compose
CLASS 3	Working day: sketch, compose, worked example
CLASS 4	Working day: compare to references, mix like the genre
CLASS 5	Working day: expand, refine, mix
CLASS 6	Mix · reflect · bounce · checklist · rubric
CLASS 7	Presentations with Padlet Q&A

FIVE STEPS, RESEARCH TO MIX



Then write your reflection, bounce, present and get feedback

- Research: pick and analyze a genre
- Listen: study 2–3 references
- Sketch, then compose the full form
- Mix to match the genre's sound

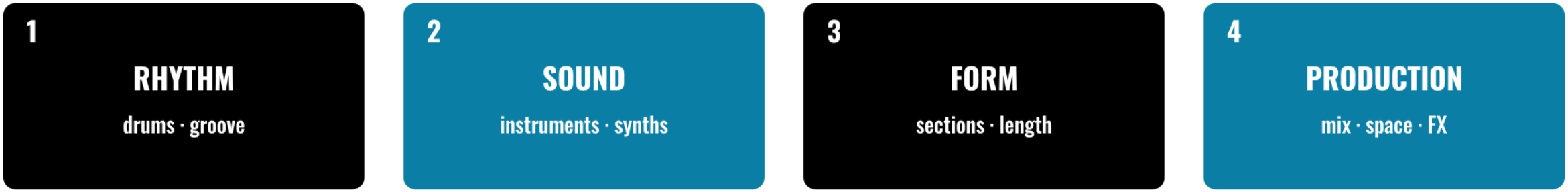
FOUR WORDS TO KNOW

- Genre: a category defined by shared traits
- Reference track: a song you study as your guide
- Instrumentation: the instruments and sounds used
- Song form: how a song is structured

STEPS 1 AND 2: RESEARCH, LISTEN

1. Select a genre you do not already make
2. Complete the Google Form on its key characteristics
3. Study 2–3 reference tracks
4. Break down their elements
5. Write what you hear on the log

A GENRE HAS A FINGERPRINT



Four things to find in a genre before you compose

- Rhythm: the groove
- Sound: instruments and synths
- Form: how the song is built
- Production: how it is mixed

INSTRUMENTS ARE NOT ENOUGH

- Commit fully, not just one instrument
- Use sounds that belong to the genre
- Apply genre-appropriate mixing and production
- Compare your mix to your references

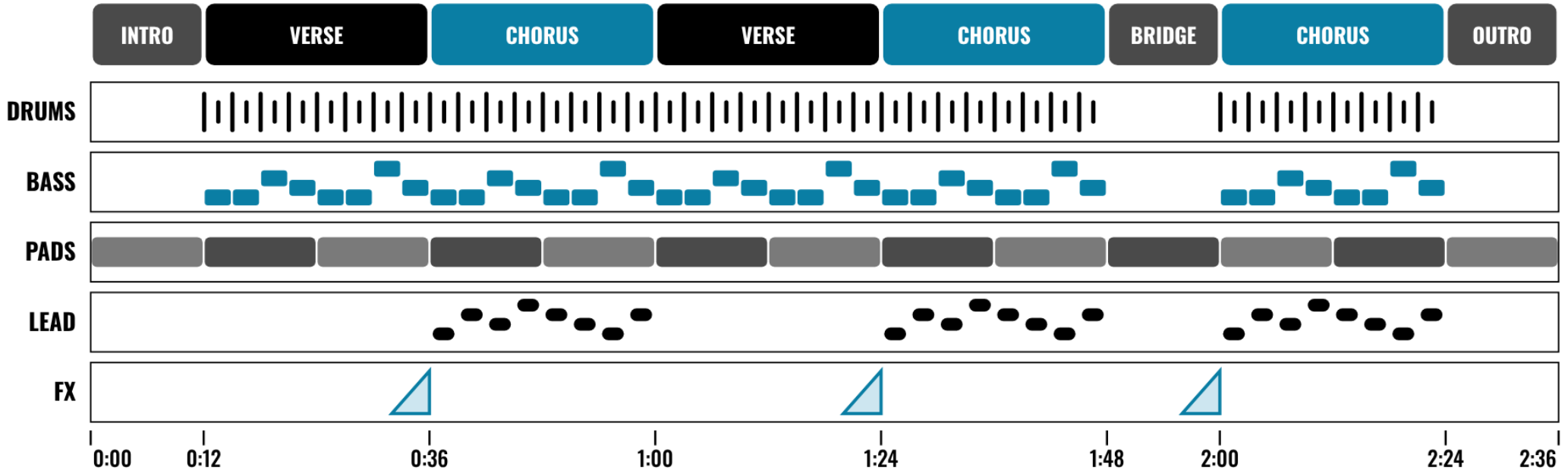
BEFORE YOU COMPOSE

- [ ] A genre I am not comfortable producing in
- [ ] Google Form research completed
- [ ] 2–3 reference tracks studied
- [ ] Rhythm, sound, form and production noted
- [ ] My teacher has seen my genre

STEPS 3 AND 4: SKETCH, COMPOSE

1. Build an 8–16 bar loop that captures the genre’s essence
2. Develop the full song structure
3. Layer instrumentation and refine
4. Follow typical song forms of the genre

WORKED EXAMPLE: INVENTED GENRE



- An invented genre, on paper
- Layers that come and go
- Sections you can name
- Space is part of the genre

USE YOUR REFERENCES CONSTANTLY

- Pull a reference into Logic and compare your mix
- Listen: does yours feel the same?
- Don’t be afraid to sound weird to yourself
- Your Google Form research will save you time

MIX LIKE THE GENRE

- Step 5: apply genre-appropriate mixing techniques
- Polish the track
- Harder option: name 2 genre-specific mixing techniques
- Leave a full class for the final mix

MIX, REFLECT, BOUNCE

1. Mix: apply genre-appropriate techniques, polish
2. Write your reflection, 1 paragraph minimum
3. Finalize your bounce
4. Create your Padlet post with 3 questions
5. Prepare to present

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Genre Research Google Form
- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Genre Exploration
- [ ] Written reflection on your class page
- [ ] Padlet post with your 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates' posts

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc	/ 5
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery	/ 5

SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your track
- Say which genre you chose and what defines it
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3

ONE LAST THING...

- You left your comfort zone.
- You studied the genre.
- You made it sound right.
- Now play it.

